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After capturing the most entertaining and enthralling match of the fortnight, Djokovic told the crowd, "It was really anyone's match in the super tie-break. These are the kind of moments I still play tennis for." Roddick, who once played contemporaneously with a young Djokovic, marvelled at the veteran's performance, saying, "It was a fantastic show of physicality. I don't know how he does it at 39."

Fery-tale showing

British hopes were dashed when former No. 4 Jack Draper withdrew due to a recurrence of a left-arm injury after reaching the Eastbourne semifinals, and veteran left-hander Cameron Norrie lost a five-set marathon to American college star Michael Zheng. Not to worry, though. Little-known Arthur Fery (**above**), a 5'9" giantkiller, filled that void with a Fery-tale semifinal run (if you'll excuse the pun).

Born in Sevres, France, he attended high school in England and starred in tennis at Stanford



Fading force: Novak Djokovic looked more ageing than ageless in his semifinal loss to Sinner. AFP

University in the U.S. His mother, Olivia, competed on the pro tour, appearing in the 1991 Roland Garros women's doubles draw, and his father, Loic, is a French businessman and the president of football club FC Lorient. The 24-year-old Fery, who lives a convenient five minutes from Wimbledon, burst onto the pro scene with a stunning 7-6(1), 6-4, 6-1 victory over No. 22 seed Cobolli at the Australian Open.

It was no fluke. Wimbledon awarded No. 114-ranked Fery a wild card, and the 500-1 longshot toppled Finnish qualifier Otto Virtanen (who had upset Ben Shelton), Zizou Bergs (who knocked out No. 27 Ugo Humbert) 7-6 in the fifth set, former Wimbledon semifinalist Grigor Dimitrov 7-6 in the fifth set, and No. 9 Cobolli 6-4, 7-6(4), 6-0 in the quarterfinals.

The marathon match between Fery and Dimitrov, also a wild card,